

Interest Group Annual Report

Darwin Core

Web Site: <https://www.tdwg.org/community/dwc/>

Convener(s):	
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Mode of work:

The core group manages activities openly using GitHub issues and announcements through social media. At times private email discussions supplement this when there are discussions about how best to accomplish something, or to strategize on making progress. These do not enter the public record. All activities conducted by the Maintenance Group are voluntary.

Phase of work:

As the Interest Group is a Maintenance Group, we are entirely in a maintenance phase, where the goal is to respond to community demand to improve the standard and provide support.

Activities:

- Following the alignment of the Darwin Core standard with the SDS and VMS, the organization of all open issues tracked in GitHub in 2020, the major activity of 2021 was to progress the large backlog of open change issues and shepherd them through the public review process. Preparations began in February, the public review was opened in May, and concluded in July.
- Support of Darwin Core has continued by actively responding to issues raised during public review.
- The Maintenance Group participated in two public webinars to explain how it's activities are conducted, using the 2021 public review as a backdrop.
- As a result of the public review process in 2021, the Maintenance Group recognized that the assessment of a change being non-normative can be subjective, and so decided that

going forward all issues that are not simple changes in grammar or spelling will go through public review.

- During the public review, the tools and processes to semi-automate the updates to the standard were refined, making them both easier and more readily usable for other vocabulary standards.
- Following the public review, the Darwin Core web site was refined to provide easy access to every aspect of the standard through its most popular document, "The Darwin Core Quick Reference Guide", including an integration via the menu system to the controlled vocabularies and the new ChronometricAge Extension.
- Controlled vocabularies
- Support of Darwin Core has continued by responding to questions submitted via the Darwin Core Questions & Answers GitHub repository, and by producing additional documentation as a result of the discussions that arise there.
- The Maintenance Group assisted in the successful completion and incorporation of the resulting Darwin Core Extension from the Chronometric Age Task Group under the Environmental Samples and Paleobiology Interest Group.
- The Maintenance Group assisted in the successful completion of the MlXS Task Group, resurrecting and finishing the alignment of the MlXS standard with Darwin Core.
- The Maintenance Group participated in the ongoing work of the Humboldt Core Task Group to define terms and an extension for ecological and monitoring data.
- The Maintenance Group held dual sessions of its working group meeting in conjunction with the TDWG annual meeting, in which further explanations of how the Maintenance Group functions and expected upcoming activities.

Accomplishments:

- New release of the standard, Darwin Core: 2021-08-24, <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5251698>.

Impediments to progress:

- Lack of funding translates into lack of time that can be prioritized to support the activities of the Maintenance Group.
- Not having an in-person working group meeting at the Annual Meeting. Little work was actually accomplished in the online replacement to this meeting, though it was very good for educating the community where we stand and how the process works.

Changes in goals or scope

In the coming year, in addition to normal activities to support the standard, the Maintenance Group will engage heavily, including a contract to convener Wieczorek, with the [GBIF initiative](#) to diversify the biodiversity data publishing and aggregations models. This work began in 2021 with the development and dissemination for review of a

series of use cases cast in terms of Event-based conceptual and publishing models that overcome the current limitations of the Darwin Core Archive star schema.

Plans for next calendar year

- Hold a public review of outstanding change requests beginning in the first quarter of 2022.
- Support the GBIF initiative to develop diversified biodiversity data models.
- Continue to support community use of the standard through the Darwin Core Question & Answers site and solicited consultations. (Ongoing)